

The water demand behind AI

Posted by u/EchoOfOppenheimer • 0 points • 45 comments

Every prompt sent to an AI like ChatGPT requires powerful computers running inside massive data centers.

Comments

u/deadlyrepost • 1 points • 2026-02-10 11:09 UTC

500ml of water, not 500 liters. The caption in the back is correct.

u/Fin-Park • 1 points • 2025-12-26 00:24 UTC

The video calling out sam altman wasn't generated using AI....right?

u/Sofi_Alva • 1 points • 2025-12-25 23:37 UTC

Do you use Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, or similar platforms? Do you spend hours browsing the internet? Is your Google Drive full of photos you no longer remember?

Every action online depends on servers.

Servers require cooling systems, and cooling consumes large amounts of electricity through fans or water-based refrigeration.

Like it or not, you are part of the problem, no matter if you use AI or not

u/HolevoBound • 1 points • 2025-12-25 13:05 UTC

You use significantly more water than this washing your clothes.

u/JumpingAround44 • 1 points • 2025-12-25 09:58 UTC

I'm not an AI apologist but: Depending on how efficient the data centers liquid cooling loops are they actually only 'waste' a small amount of the water being put in to them - mostly because of evaporation which is lead out to become rain clouds.- what I haven't counted here is whatever else they are using water for, and its because I don't know.

u/kaba40k • 1 points • 2025-12-25 10:21 UTC

There should be nothing "wasted" at all. Normally, it should be water that needs to be available for cooling (thus logically not available for other tasks), but it does not "disappear" or gets polluted or gets infected.

u/skarrrrrrr • 1 points • 2025-12-25 02:11 UTC

of course it had to be the BBC lol